

Cisco's new bandwidth glut

Cisco has just released their high-speed 322 Tbps routing system that should be able to power and incredible online future

Lockheed Martin beefs up security

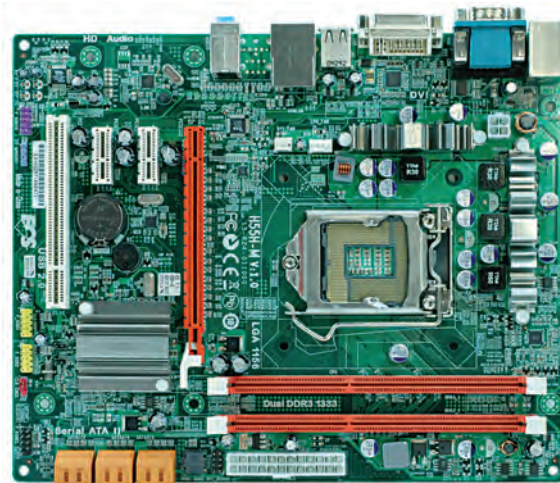
The top contractor for the US government plans to find new ways to predict and prevent wide-scale cyber attacks, and secure classified information

ECS A890GXM-A

Back in Black?

Based on the 890GX Northbridge along with the SB850 Southbridge, this is AMD's shiny new offering with support for upcoming 6-core CPUs. The layout of the motherboard is very neat and with an attractive heatsink. The PCIe slot is thoughtfully a good distance away from the PCI slot. The BIOS is a little basic, and we expected more overclocking options and features.

In addition to two PCIe x1 slots, one PCI slot the motherboard 2 PCIe x16 slots for graphics interface. The board comes with a CrossfireX support to link graphics solutions.



Sadly there is no support for USB 3.0 on this motherboard. The board has five SATA 3.0 ports which are capable of a 6Gb/s data transfer speed. There is a CMOS reset button between the HDMI and eSATA

port columns. Both DVI and VGA video output connections are present.

At Rs. 7,500 this motherboard is decently priced, although the Gigabyte GA-890GPA-UD3H might make more sense, given the mere Rs. 1,000 difference in price.

Specifications

AM3 Socket, Chipset : AMD 890GX, graphics : HD4290, 14 USB2.0 ports, 5 SATA 3.0 ports, Power supply : EPS 12V, Audio : Realtek ALC892

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Price: Rs. 7,500



For a detailed review, go to http://thinkdigit.com/d/ecs_a890gx/

Specifications

CPU Support AMD AM3

PhenomII/ AthlonII CPU

CPU Socket AMD Socket AM3

FSB 5200MT/s (HT3.0)

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Gigabyte GA-890GPA-UD3H

A new breed

GA890GPA-UD3H is based on the new 890GX platform from AMD. The PCB is blue colored. At first glance the quality is evident — heatsinks, MOSFETs, capacitors, chokes — everything seems premium-grade. The design of the northbridge and southbridge heatsinks has a larger surface area. The BIOS is pretty rich and typical of Gigabyte with a lot of settings and overclocking options to play with.

This board has support for USB3.0 thanks to the NEC



Read more on the 890GPA at http://thinkdigit.com/d/ga_890ud3h/

USB 3.0 controller chip which is located just behind the ports

On the other side of the board we have six SATA 3.0 ports, along with two SATA 2.0 ports which is supported by the SATA 2 chipset.

The processor cooler leaves very little gap to insert a memory stick in the RAM slots.

The price point of Rs. 8,500 is on the higher side, but then, if this were an Intel X58-based motherboard, it'd probably be priced at Rs.

17,000. It has a good feature set, will support the upcoming 6-core CPUs and is thus quite future proof. A good option for AMD builds.



7/10

Features.....7
Performance.....7
Build quality.....7.5
Value for money.....6.5